vciso advisory

VCISO & ADVISORY

Add structured security leadership without giving up decision ownership.

Work with a defined advisory service to shape security strategy, governance, risk decisions, architecture reviews, executive reporting and readiness — with named scope, cadence, evidence and clear customer authority.

Book a Demo | Review Advisory Scope | Visit Trust Center

ROLE BOUNDARY

Security leadership support — not a borrowed executive title.

The service is valuable because it creates structured leadership support with visible decision ownership and evidence. It does not substitute for accountable internal governance.

What the service does

Within an agreed, contracted scope.

- ☐ Provides **structured security-leadership advice** against a named scope.
- ☐ Facilitates **evidence-linked priorities**, roadmap and decisions.
- ☐ Defines **cadence, owners, exceptions** and follow-through.
- ☐ Prepares **evidence-linked executive and Board materials**.
- ☐ Supports **control and evidence readiness** and remediation governance.
- ☐ States a **verified meeting and communication model**.

What it does not do

Regardless of how the engagement is packaged.

- ○ Become your CISO. Officer, statutory or delegated appointment is a **separate legal process**.
- ○ Hold unilateral **policy or risk-acceptance authority**.
- ○ Determine **materiality** or speak for the Board.
- ○ Issue **certification, audit opinion** or regulator acceptance.
- ○ Provide **legal advice** or determine a regulatory position.
- ○ Operate detection and response, or perform **independent testing**, unless separately contracted.

No outcome guarantee

Advisory can improve clarity, governance and follow-through. It does not guarantee prevention, compliance, certification, regulator acceptance, audit results, business continuity, insurance coverage or the absence of incidents.

DECISION RIGHTS

The authority line, drawn decision by decision.

The advisor analyzes, drafts, facilitates and records. Every consequential decision stays with a named, authorized person on your side unless a separate verified delegation says otherwise.

DECISION CLASS	ADVISOR ROLE	YOUR AUTHORITY
Recommendation	Analyzes options, evidence, tradeoffs and next steps.	Authorized leader decides whether to act.
Policy proposal	Drafts or reviews language and implications.	Policy owner approves and publishes.
Risk treatment	Facilitates options and supporting evidence.	Risk owner accepts, mitigates, transfers or avoids.
Architecture	Reviews controls and tradeoffs, records concerns.	Design authority approves implementation.
Vendor selection	Supports security diligence and remediation conditions.	Procurement or business owner selects and contracts.
Board materials	Prepares evidence-linked briefing and questions.	Executives and Board own statements and decisions.
Incident action	Advises based on the readiness and authority model.	Incident authority or a separate service executes.
Regulatory position	Identifies the issue for qualified review.	Legal, compliance or an authorized officer determines it.
Exception / waiver	Assesses security impact and conditions.	Named exception or risk authority approves.

No service card, advisor profile or deliverable may imply the advisor can bind you, accept risk, sign regulatory statements, direct employees or approve spend.

VCISO & ADVISORY

Add structured security leadership without giving up decision ownership.

Work with a defined advisory service to shape security strategy, governance, risk decisions, architecture reviews, executive reporting and readiness — with named scope, cadence, evidence and clear customer authority.

- SERVICE STATE: CONDITIONAL
- ADVISOR: ROLE-BASED
- CADENCE: PER ENGAGEMENT
- WCAG 2.2 AA

Book a Demo

Review Advisory Scope

Visit Trust Center

Already a customer? Use the account and support routes below — not this form. Active incident? Go straight to the incident activation route.

ADVISORY CONTRACT CARD ZS-WEB-SVC-ADVISORY-024

What is fixed, and what your engagement sets

Role boundaries are fixed by the service doctrine. Everything commercial or scheduling-related comes from your approved proposal — never from this page.

Role	Advisory — not an appointment
Decision authority	Customer retains
Scope	Per engagement
Cadence	Per engagement
Time model	Per engagement
Availability	Per engagement
Named advisor	On approval
Deliverables	Per engagement

Boundary. Advisory support does not by itself appoint a statutory CISO or officer, provide legal advice, issue audit opinions, operate 24/7 response, or guarantee compliance or security outcomes.

ROUTE /SERVICES/ADVISORY FAMILY SERVICES

STATE CONDITIONAL

NEXT PENETRATION TESTING

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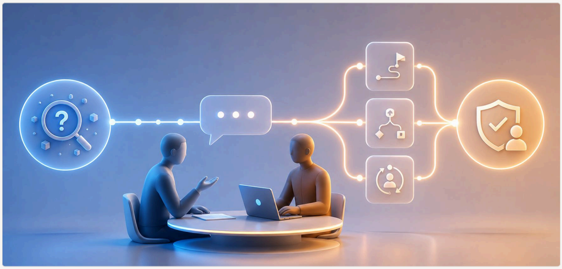
- ☐ Defines **cadence, owners, exceptions** and follow-through.
- ☐ Prepares **evidence-linked executive and Board materials**.
- ☐ Supports **control and evidence readiness** and remediation

ADVISORY FIT

Tell us the need. We'll say plainly whether this is the right path.

This selector explains relevance from what you declare. It does not score your maturity, infer urgency, preselect a package or record a security profile.



SCOPE CATALOG

Nine workstreams, each with a stated edge.

Exclusions are shown here, before qualification — and again near commercial conversion. There is no "full CISO function" package.

01

Strategy & roadmap

Objectives, priorities, sequencing, owners and a decision record you can replay later.

BOUNDARY

`No promise that every initiative will be executed.`

02

Risk governance

Risk taxonomy, review rhythm, treatment and exception facilitation.

BOUNDARY

`Customer-authorized roles accept or transfer risk.`

03

Policy & controls

Governance model, policy review, framework mappings and remediation ownership.

BOUNDARY

`No compliance or certification guarantee.`

04

Architecture

Security requirements, tradeoff analysis, design and vendor review.

BOUNDARY

`Engineering implementation remains assigned to your teams.`

05

Third parties

Due-diligence criteria, risk review and decision support for procurement.

BOUNDARY

`No legal or vendor warranty.`

06

Executive reporting

Evidence-linked summaries and decision preparation for executives and the Board.

BOUNDARY

`No fiduciary or materiality decision.`

07

Incident readiness

Plans, exercises, authority models and communication preparation.

BOUNDARY

`No IR entitlement unless separately contracted.`

08

Team enablement

Roles, operating rhythms, coaching and handoffs between functions.

BOUNDARY

`No HR or employment decision authority.`

09

Assurance support

Evidence gaps, remediation governance and auditor coordination.

BOUNDARY

`No independent audit opinion.`

HOW THE ENGAGEMENT WORKS

A repeating loop, not a series of meetings.

The cycle below is how advisory operates. How often it runs, who attends and how long each session lasts come from your approved service package — a website layout cannot create a frequency entitlement.

01 **Prepare**	02 **Advise**	03 **Decide**	04 **Assign**	05 **Evidence**	06 **Review**	07 **Adjust**
Pre-read, evidence bundle and agenda circulated before the session.	Options, tradeoffs and limitations laid out against current evidence.	Your authorized decider records the outcome and its effective date.	Actions get an accountable owner, due date, dependency and priority.	Decisions and artifacts are versioned — not left in a slide deck or a chat thread.	Open decisions, overdue actions and accepted exceptions are revisited.	Scope fit, consumption and outcomes assessed at the term review.

governance.

- ☐ States a **verified meeting and communication model**.

What it does not do

Regardless of how the engagement is packaged.

- ○ Become your CISO. Officer, statutory or delegated appointment is a **separate legal process**.
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Advisory can improve clarity, governance and follow-through. It does not guarantee prevention, compliance, certification, regulator acceptance, audit results, business continuity, insurance coverage or the absence of incidents.

DECISION RIGHTS

The authority line, drawn decision by decision.

The advisor analyzes, drafts, facilitates and records. Every consequential decision stays with a named, authorized person on your side unless a separate verified delegation says otherwise.

RECOMMENDATION

ADVISOR ROLE – Analyzes options, evidence, tradeoffs and next steps.

Authorized leader decides whether to act.

POLICY PROPOSAL

ADVISOR ROLE – Drafts or reviews language and implications.

Policy owner approves and publishes.

RISK TREATMENT

ADVISOR ROLE – Facilitates options and supporting evidence.

Risk owner accepts, mitigates, transfers or avoids.

ARCHITECTURE

ADVISOR ROLE – Reviews controls and tradeoffs, records concerns.

Design authority approves implementation.

VENDOR SELECTION

ADVISOR ROLE – Supports security diligence and remediation conditions.

Procurement or business owner selects and contracts.

BOARD MATERIALS

ADVISOR ROLE – Prepares evidence-linked briefing and questions.

Executives and Board own statements and decisions.

INCIDENT ACTION

Meeting types the model supports

- **Standing advisory review** — agenda owner, pre-read, decision types, minutes.
- **Executive or Board preparation** — reporting period, source evidence, review chain, your approver.
- **Risk review** — risk population, change threshold, owners, exceptions.
- **Architecture or vendor review** — trigger, intake, evidence, decision criteria.
- **Incident-readiness review** — contacts, plans, exercise status, escalation authority.
- **Ad-hoc session** — how it's requested, what qualifies, and how time is consumed.

What you keep afterwards

- **Advisory brief** — question, evidence, assumptions, options, recommendation, limitations.
- **Decision register** — options, rationale, authority, approver, conditions, supersession.
- **Action register** — owner, due date, dependency, evidence, status, escalation.
- **Meeting record** — participants, decisions, actions and evidence links.
- **Consumption record** — period, units used, remaining, corrections and disputes.
- **Offboarding package** — current artifacts, open risks, access revocation, transition status.

EVIDENCE PRINCIPLE

`Advisory value stays inspectable after the meeting. Overdue items keep a visible state — there is no silent reset.`

HOURS AND RETAINER MODEL

A balance of hours is not an availability guarantee.

Here is every field that must be defined before a time model is published. The values are commercial terms and come from your proposal or order form — this page creates none of them.

- **Unit** — hour, half-day, day, session or another exact unit.
- **Included amount** — quantity and period. Never implied by card size or plan name.
- **Consumption** — what counts: meetings, preparation, analysis, deliverable production, async review, specialist time.
- **Minimum increment** — rounding, billing increment and time-zone basis.
- **Scheduling** — request channel, lead time, availability window and confirmation state.
- **Rollover or expiry** — whether unused units carry, cap, convert or lapse.
- **Overage** — approval, rate source, caps and alerts. No automatic surprise charges.
- **Visibility** — you can inspect committed, used, remaining, disputed and corrected units.

Blocked language

"Access to a vCISO", "on demand", "always available" and "24/7 CISO" are not used unless scheduling, coverage, response expectations and capacity rules are explicitly authorized for your engagement.

NAMED ADVISOR MODEL

A person is named when a person is verified.

Until a profile is approved for public display, the service is described by role. There is no badge wall standing in for service outcomes.

NOT NAMED

Security Advisor

Role-based service card. A display name, legal relationship and credentials appear only when each is current, verified and approved for publication.

● PROFILE: PENDING APPROVAL

Continuity, substitution and conflicts

- **Substitution** — eligibility and equivalence criteria, plus disclosure and your approval rights, are defined before the engagement depends on one person.
- **Planned absence** — notification, handoff, open decisions and coverage effect stated in advance.
- **Unexpected absence** — fallback contact, service state and rescheduling rule.
- **Specialists** — named category, approval path, and whether their time consumes your units.
- **Region and language** — published only when verified. An office location is not service coverage.
- **Conflicts** — relevant conflicts are disclosed and managed through engagement governance, with an ethical escalation path.
- **Knowledge continuity** — the decision log, roadmap, evidence and action register reduce dependence on any individual.

ROLE BOUNDARY

`The term "vCISO" cannot by itself establish officer status, fiduciary duty, employment, regulated function, signatory authority or personal liability allocation.`

RELATED SERVICES

ADVISOR ROLE – Advises based on the readiness and authority model.

Incident authority or a separate service executes.

REGULATORY POSITION

ADVISOR ROLE – Identifies the issue for qualified review.

Legal, compliance or an authorized officer determines it.

EXCEPTION / WAIVER

ADVISOR ROLE – Assesses security impact and conditions.

Named exception or risk authority approves.

`No service card, advisor profile or deliverable may imply the advisor can bind you, accept risk, sign regulatory statements, direct employees or approve spend.`

ADVISORY FIT

Tell us the need. We'll say plainly whether this is the right path.

This selector explains relevance from what you declare. It does not score your maturity, infer urgency, preselect a package or record a security profile.

- Establish a program
- Board reporting
- Policies & controls
- Architecture & vendors
- Incident readiness
- Run detection
- Independent testing
- Active incident

Advisory fits this directly.

Strategy, governance, ownership and roadmap discovery — establishing what the program is, who owns each part, and how decisions get made and recorded.

ALSO CONSIDER

If the gap is ongoing control evidence rather than structure:

Continuous Assurance →

Related services are independent packages. None is a prerequisite, bundled default, free inclusion or maturity tier for another.

SCOPE CATALOG

Nine workstreams, each with a stated edge.

Exclusions are shown here, before qualification — and again near commercial conversion. There is no "full CISO function" package.

01

Strategy & roadmap

Objectives, priorities, sequencing, owners and a decision record you can replay later.

BOUNDARY

`No promise that every initiative will be executed.`

02

Risk governance

Risk taxonomy, review rhythm, treatment and exception facilitation.

BOUNDARY

`Customer-authorized roles accept or transfer risk.`

Four independent paths. No bundle, no prerequisite, no tier.

Advisory sits alongside these services. It is never a mandatory step toward them, and none of them is automatically included here.

DIMENSION	VCISO & ADVISORY	ADJACENT SERVICE
`primary job`	Security leadership, governance, decisions and program support.	**Managed Defense** — operates detection, investigation and response.
`evidence job`	Interprets and governs what evidence is needed.	**Continuous Assurance** — ongoing control and evidence assurance.
`incident job`	Prepares governance and advises on readiness.	**IR Retainer** — annual readiness plus activation service.
`assessment job`	Defines objectives and interprets findings.	**Penetration Testing** — scoped authorized testing and retest.
`authority`	Recommends and facilitates within the contract.	Operational and assessment rights follow each service contract.
`commercial`	Named advisory scope, cadence and time model.	Independent packages. No automatic inclusion.

Compare starting paths **Managed Defense** **Continuous Assurance** **IR Retainer**

TRUST AND PROCUREMENT

What diligence teams can ask for.

Evidence for procurement is versioned and owned. Nothing here creates a commitment that the proposal or order form does not already carry.

§

Service and scope

Public versioned service description with a named owner and state, plus scope and exclusion detail in the proposal.

◇

Security and privacy

Trust Center authority, engagement data handling, secure channels, and subprocessor disclosure from Legal and Privacy.

Continuity and coverage

Service continuity and substitution summary — published only where verified. Capacity is never marketed as unlimited.

√

Credentials

Current, scoped and source-verified only. Credentials are not offered as proof of service outcomes.

Sample deliverables

Synthetic or redacted and clearly labelled as illustrative. No real customer material.

DPA and questionnaires

Controlled procurement routes with a named version owner. References and case studies are permissioned and claim-reviewed.

Visit Trust Center **Data processing agreement**

GETTING TO THE RIGHT PLACE

Not every question belongs in a sales form.

Existing-customer service problems and active incidents are never converted into a demo flow. If a route is unavailable, the page shows the approved fallback and status rather than redirecting quietly.

Active security incident	Urgency outranks sales and advisory intake. Do not qualify through this page.	`Incident activation →`
Evaluating advisory	Share declared needs — not confidential security detail — and we'll scope from there.	`Book a Demo →`
Question about a current engagement	Goes to your account team with context preserved. It is not treated as a new lead.	`Contact account team →`
Scheduling or consumption	Current authoritative units and engagement state live in the portal.	`Engagement operations →`
Scope or contract change	Handled as a change request. No advisor makes a commercial commitment alone.	`Raise a change request →`
Vulnerability in a ZoikoShield product	Goes to coordinated disclosure — never to advisory sales.	`Vulnerability disclosure →`
Product outage	This page does not invent live service status.	`System Status →`

DIRECT ANSWERS

The questions buyers ask before procurement does.

What is ZoikoShield vCISO & Advisory? −

A defined security-leadership advisory service covering agreed strategy, governance, risk, architecture, reporting and readiness workstreams — with named scope, a governance cadence and an hours or retainer model set by your engagement.

Does the vCISO become our company CISO? +

`03`

Policy & controls

Governance model, policy review, framework mappings and remediation ownership.

BOUNDARY

`No compliance or certification guarantee.`

`04`

Architecture

Security requirements, tradeoff analysis, design and vendor review.

BOUNDARY

`Engineering implementation remains assigned to your teams.`

`05`

Third parties

Due-diligence criteria, risk review and decision support for procurement.

BOUNDARY

`No legal or vendor warranty.`

`06`

Executive reporting

Evidence-linked summaries and decision preparation for executives and the Board.

BOUNDARY

`No fiduciary or materiality decision.`

`07`

Incident readiness

Plans, exercises, authority models and communication preparation.

BOUNDARY

`No IR entitlement unless separately contracted.`

`08`

Team enablement

Roles, operating rhythms, coaching and handoffs between functions.

BOUNDARY

`No HR or employment decision authority.`

`09`

Assurance support

Evidence gaps, remediation governance and auditor coordination.

BOUNDARY

`No independent audit opinion.`

HOW THE ENGAGEMENT WORKS

A repeating loop, not a series of meetings.

The cycle below is how advisory operates. How often it runs, who attends and how long each session lasts come from your approved service package — a website layout cannot create a frequency entitlement.

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Prepare
Pre-read, evidence bundle and agenda circulated before the session.

02
Advise
Options, tradeoffs and limitations laid out against current evidence.

03
Decide
Your authorized decider records the outcome and its effective date.

04
Assign
Actions get an accountable owner, due date, dependency and priority.

05
Evidence
Decisions and artifacts are versioned — not left in a slide deck or a chat thread.

What does the advisor actually decide?

How often do we meet?

How many hours are included, and do unused hours roll over?

Is the advisor available 24/7?

Can the advisor guarantee compliance or audit success?

Can the advisor perform incident response or penetration testing?

Can the advisor present to our Board?

How is our confidential data handled?

What happens if our named advisor changes?

GET STARTED

Scope it properly before you sign anything.

Bring the need, not the confidential detail. We'll walk the scope, the cadence options, the time model and — just as carefully — what stays your decision.

Book a Demo | Review Advisory Scope | Compare starting paths

`Advisor identity, cadence, included hours, availability, deliverables, commercial terms and delegated authority vary by approved engagement.`

06
Review
Open decisions, overdue actions and accepted exceptions are revisited.

07
Adjust
Scope fit, consumption and outcomes assessed at the term review.

Meeting types the model supports

- **Standing advisory review** — agenda owner, pre-read, decision types, minutes.
- **Executive or Board preparation** — reporting period, source evidence, review chain, your approver.
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- **Visibility** — you can inspect committed, used, remaining, disputed and corrected units.

CONSUMPTION VIEW — STRUCTURE ONLY

🟥 Used 🟧 Committed 🟩 Remaining

⬜ Disputed

Unfilled by design. Quantities appear in your engagement portal and on your order form, never as a website default.

Blocked language

“Access to a vCISO”, “on demand”, “always available” and “24/7 CISO” are not used unless scheduling, coverage, response expectations and capacity rules are explicitly authorized for your engagement.

NAMED ADVISOR MODEL

A person is named when a person is verified.

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`authority`	Recommends and facilitates within the contract.	Operational and assessment rights follow each service contract.
`commercial`	Named advisory scope, cadence and time model.	Independent packages. No automatic inclusion.

Compare starting paths

Managed Defense

Continuous Assurance **IR Retainer**

TRUST AND PROCUREMENT

What diligence teams can ask for.

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Trust Center authority, engagement data handling, secure channels, and subprocessor disclosure from Legal and Privacy.

▣

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Active security incident

Urgency outranks sales and advisory intake. Do not qualify through this page.

Incident activation →

Evaluating advisory

Share declared needs — not confidential security detail — and we'll scope from there.

Book a Demo →

Question about a current engagement

Goes to your account team with context preserved. It is not treated as a new lead.

Contact account team →

Scheduling or consumption

Current authoritative units and engagement state live in the portal.

Engagement operations →

Scope or contract change

Handled as a change request. No advisor makes a commercial commitment alone.

Raise a change request →

Vulnerability in a ZoikoShield product

Goes to coordinated disclosure — never to advisory sales.

Vulnerability disclosure →

Product outage

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What does the advisor actually decide? +

How often do we meet? +

How many hours are included, and do unused hours roll over? +

Is the advisor available 24/7? +

Can the advisor guarantee compliance or audit success? +

Can the advisor perform incident response or penetration testing? +

Can the advisor present to our Board? +

How is our confidential data handled? +

What happens if our named advisor changes? +

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Scope it properly before you sign anything.

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Compare starting paths

Advisor identity, cadence, included hours, availability, deliverables, commercial terms and delegated authority vary by approved engagement.

Z OIKO SHIELD

Defensible cybersecurity and continuous assurance for regulated digital operations.

● SOC 2 ● ISO 27001 ● HIPAA

SERVICES

- Managed Defense
- Continuous Assurance
- vCISO & Advisory
- IR Retainer
- Penetration Testing
- Compare starting paths

PLATFORM

- Platform overview
- Evidence ledger
- Compliance control plane
- Executive Risk Intelligence

COMPANY

- About us
- Careers
- Contact

TRUST & LEGAL

- Trust Center
- Privacy policy
- Terms of service
- Vulnerability disclosure

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vCISO & Advisory · state: conditional · advisory role, customer authority retained